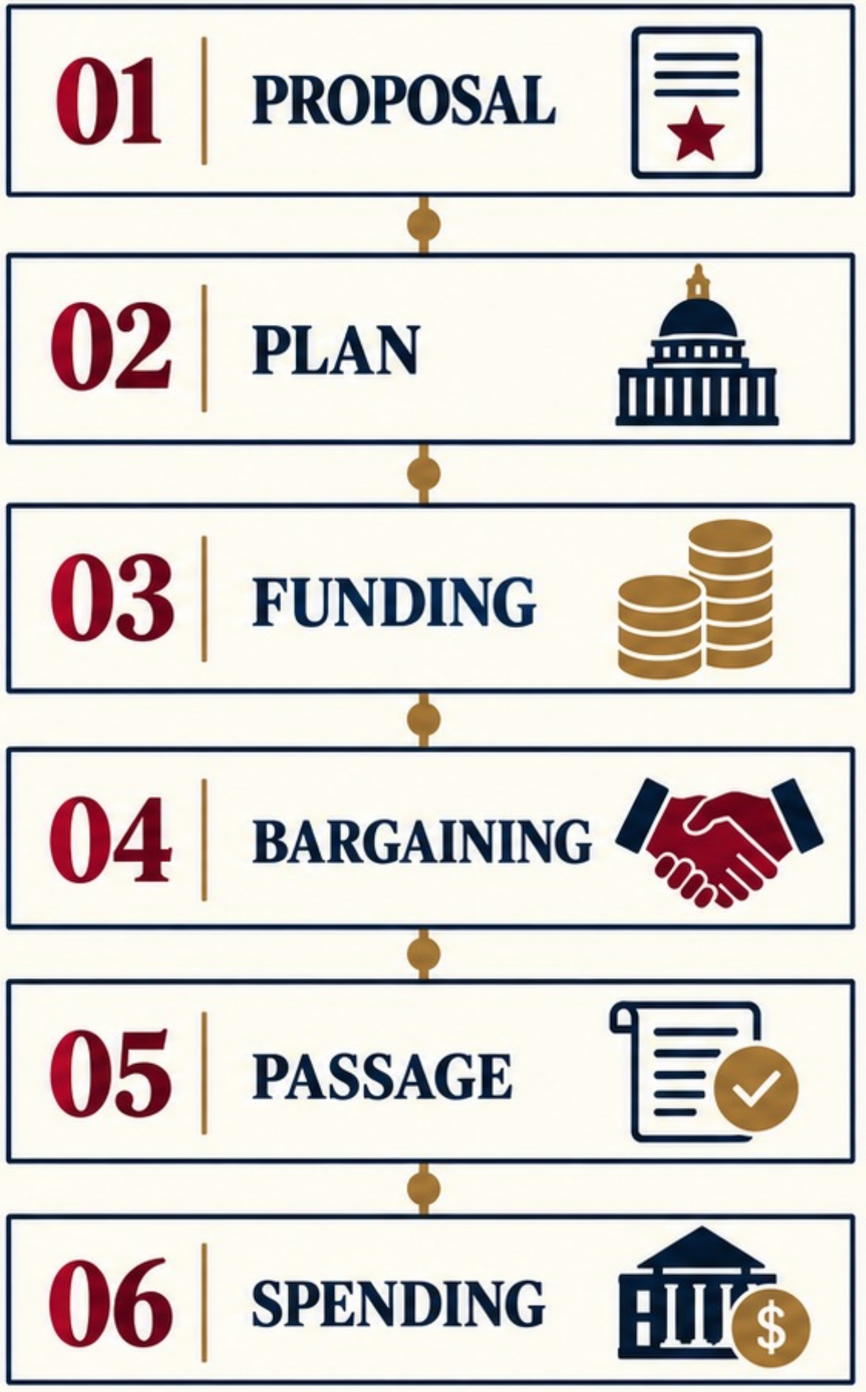
FOLLOW THE MONEY

A **BUDGET** is a plan for how government will raise and spend money.

The President proposes a plan. Congress decides which spending becomes law.



THE SPENDING MIX

01 MANDATORY SPENDING

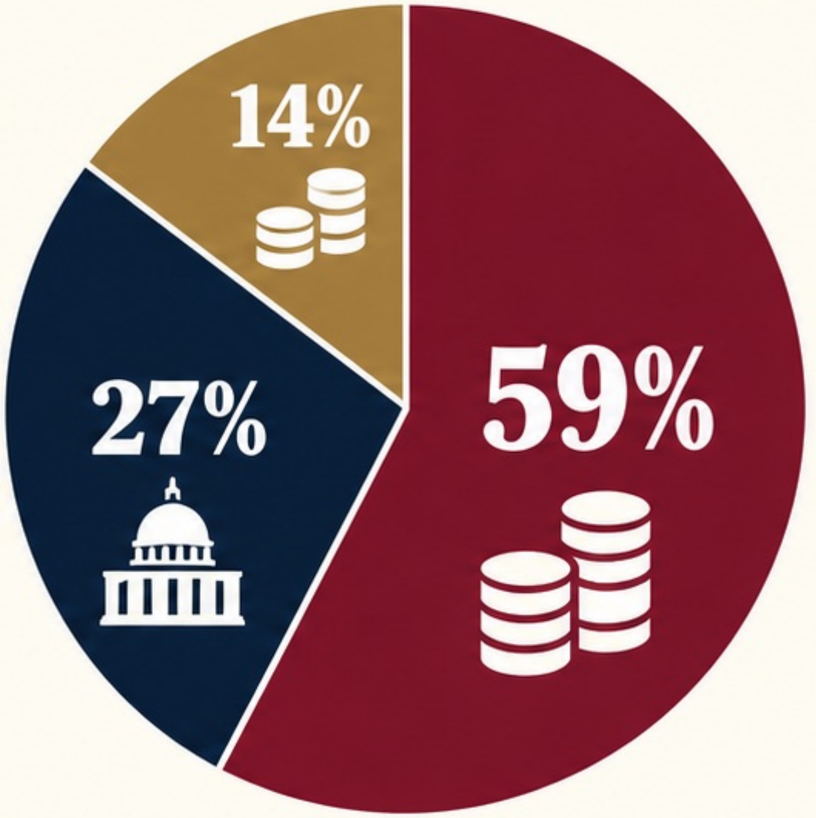
59% — Money spent under existing laws, including Social Security and Medicare.

02 DISCRETIONARY SPENDING

27% — Money Congress decides to fund through annual appropriations.

03 NET INTEREST

14% — The cost of borrowing on federal debt.



FY 2025 federal outlays • rounded shares

THE OPENING BID

The **PRESIDENT'S BUDGET PROPOSAL** is the White House's requested plan for federal spending and revenue.

Congress reviews it but makes its own choices.

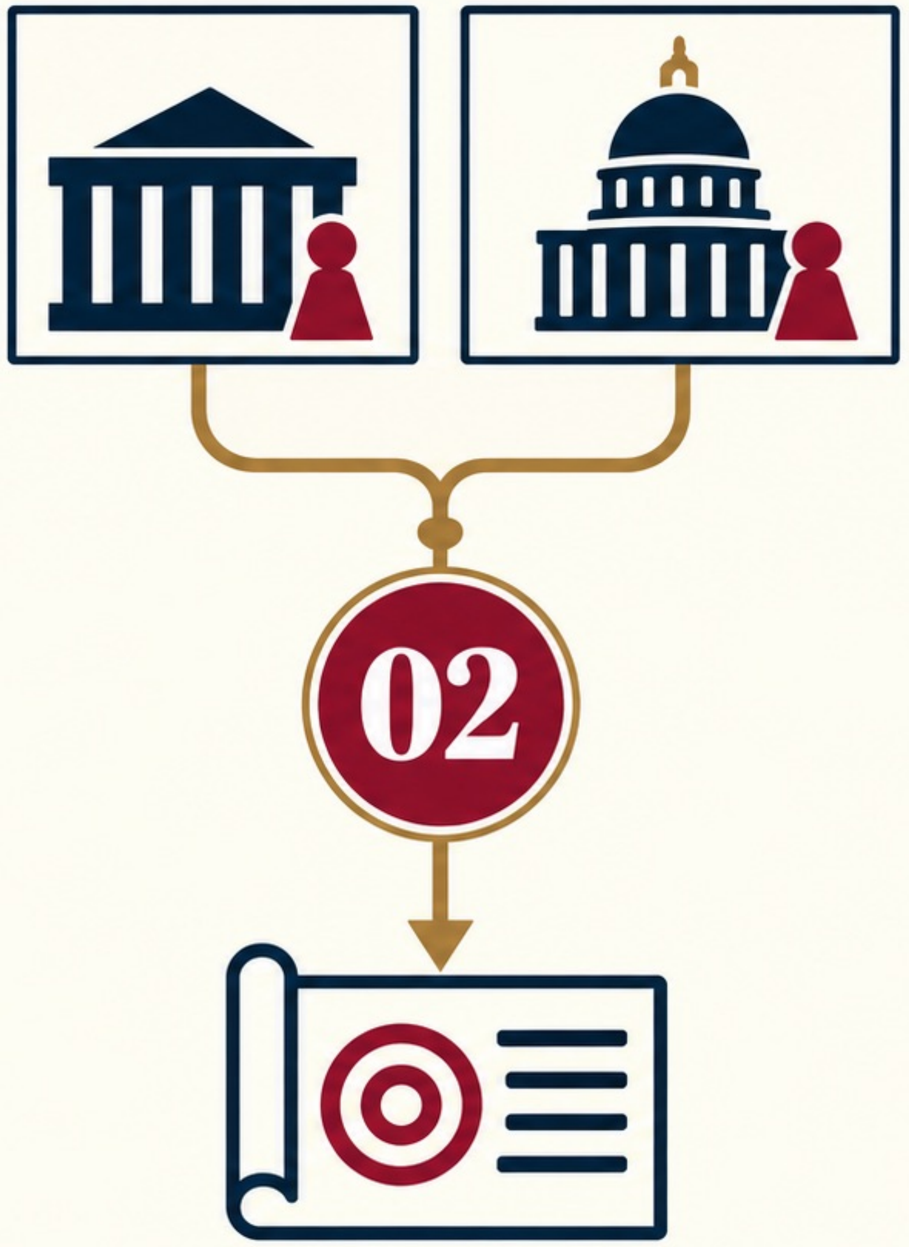


SET THE TARGETS

A **BUDGET RESOLUTION** sets Congress's spending and revenue targets.

The House and Senate must agree on it.

It is a plan, not a law that funds agencies.



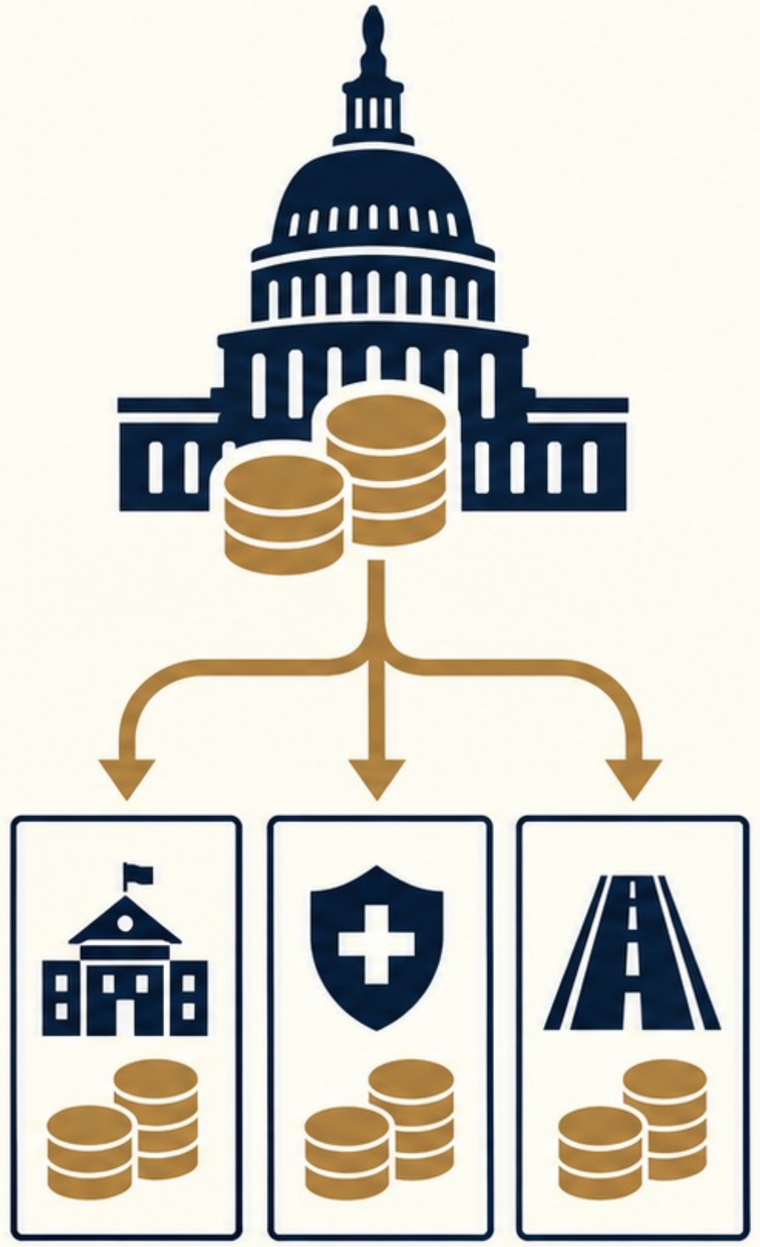
CHOOSE WHAT TO FUND

APPROPRIATIONS

are laws that provide money for federal agencies and programs.

Congress makes these choices each year for **DISCRETIONARY SPENDING.**

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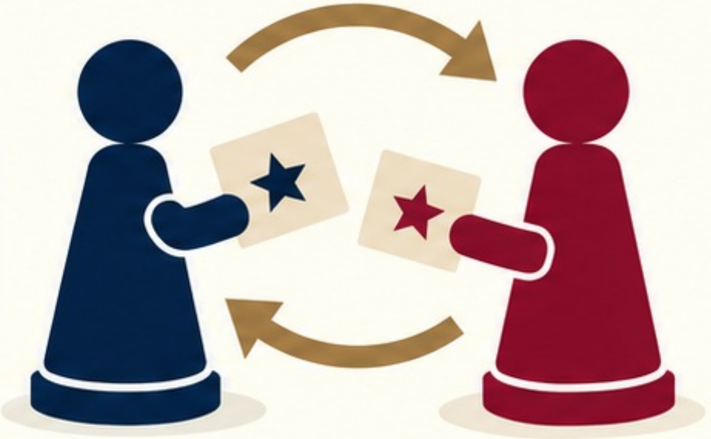
TRADE FOR SUPPORT

LOGROLLING means lawmakers trade support for each other's proposals.

PORK BARREL SPENDING directs federal money to projects in a lawmaker's state or district.

Bargaining can help build the votes a spending bill needs.

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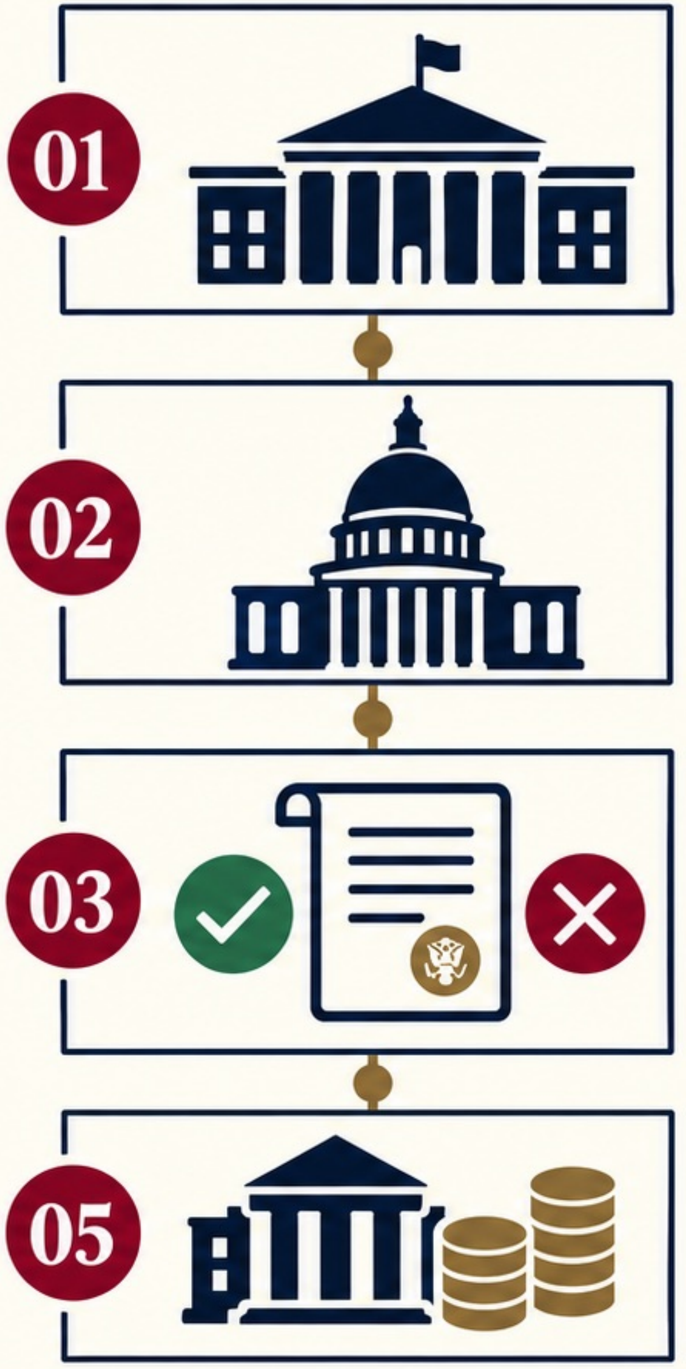


PASS OR VETO

01 **PASSAGE** means the House and Senate approve the same spending bill.

02 A **VETO** is the President's rejection of a bill.

A bill that becomes law gives agencies authority to spend.



MONEY MEETS POLICY



FEDERAL AGENCIES carry out laws and run government programs.



An enacted **SPENDING LAW** tells agencies how much money they may use.

Budget choices shape the services people receive.

06







